Oregon Department of Human Services

Licensed Child Caring Agency Unannounced Site Visit Report
Residential Care

Licensee: Family Solutions – Cascade House
Executive Director: Dorothy Provencio
Program Manager: Susan Shorey
Program Director(s): Roy Lindsay

Date of Unannounced: August 23, 2023
Licensing Coordinator: Robin DuVal, accompanied by Katie Wyland with Child Welfare Treatment Services.

Other Regulatory or Accrediting Agencies: Oregon Health Authority (OHA) and Oregon Department of Human Services Child Welfare Treatment Services (ODHS).

Purpose: Per OAR 419-400-0240(1)(b) Children's Care Licensing is required to perform at least one unannounced site visit a year where children in care reside.

Previous Findings: **License Renewal Site Visit 08/31/2022**	**Repeat Findings Further Action Needed**	**Comments or Corrective Actions**
SB710 Requirements: Policy and Procedures; notifications to guardian and children in care. OAR 419-400-0180(8)(e), (11)(e) and OAR 419-400-0190(1). • This licensor provided edits and recommendations to the notification document for guardians and children in care. The agency shall ensure the notification is updated and implemented going forward.	**Yes☐ No✓**	This notification is provided to guardians and children in care and documented as being provided. • *No further corrective action is needed at this time.* *Note: The form had an outdated email extension for the licensing contact. The agency staff person will update and ensure the new form is utilized going forward.*
Medication 419-470-0100(9) Written record of the disposal of medications is maintained and includes: (a) description and amount (b) name (c) reason (d) method (e) staff & witness signature	**Yes✓ No☐**	Requirement (9)(e) remains unmet: initials instead of signatures; and several instances with only one staff person without a witness. Some disposed medications are disposed on-site utilizing the Rx Destroyer product, however other disposed medications were in a bin labeled "disposal" with no tracking document within said bin, creating a risk of mismanagement or theft.

• (9)(e) The agency shall ensure staff and witness provide a signature, not initials. *Note: This licensor and staff discussed ways to update documentation and processes. The agency is working on updating policies and procedures to be clearer and reduce potential errors.*		When speaking to several staff and the program manager, there was a lack of clarity on the process of medication administration documentation and medication disposal and disposal documentation. There have been recent staff changes, and new hires that may not have received required training. **Corrective Action. The Agency shall:** 1) Ensure staff and a witness provide a signature, not initials. 2) Ensure two staff (one staff and one staff witness) are disposing medications and signing the disposal record. 3) Review medication policies and procedures to ensure it meets requirements in related OARs and the practices set forth by Family Solutions. 4) Ensure all staff who handle medications are provided medication policies and procedures, are trained, and demonstrate competency before administering and disposing medications as well as proper documentation. 5) Ensure management oversight for quality check and assurances and any follow-up training needed. *****This is a repeat finding.*****

Medication 419-470-0100(10) Written record of the administration of medication includes: (a) name (b) description (c) dates and times **(d) missed doses** **(e) medication disposed** (f) method of administration (g) ID of person administering (h) possible adverse reactions (i) medication taken outside facility • Requirements (10)(e) and (i) are unmet. The agency shall ensure all requirements are included on the medication administration record. *Note: This licensor and staff discussed ways to update documentation and processes. The agency is working on updating policies and procedures to be clearer and reduce potential errors.*	**Yes✓ No☐**	Requirements (10)(d) and (e) are unmet. There were several blank areas on the medication administration record with no corresponding notes to document the circumstances where space is provided for such notes on the back of the sheet. When speaking to several staff and the program manager, there was a lack of clarity on the process of medication administration documentation and medication disposal and disposal documentation. There have been recent staff changes, and new hires that may not have received required training. **Corrective Action – The Agency shall:** 1) The agency shall ensure the written record of the medication administration are filled out accurately with no blanks, indicating missed doses or medication disposed. • Medication errors, or anomalies in documentation or administration, can be documented by adding a notation to the medication administration record. 2) Review medication policies and procedures to ensure it meets requirements in related OARs and the practices set forth by Family Solutions. 3) Ensure all staff who handle medications are provided medication policies and procedures, are trained, and demonstrate competency before administering and disposing medications as well as proper documentation. 4) Ensure management oversight for quality check and assurances and any follow-up training needed. *****This is a repeat finding.*****

Children's Records Health Services 419-470-0090 (2)(e) Documentation of age-appropriate instruction – pregnancy prevention, nutrition, prevention of HIV & AIDS, and prevention and treatment of sexually transmitted disease • (2)(e) is unmet. The agency shall ensure age-appropriate instruction is provided and appropriately documented in each youth file. ***Repeat finding.***	**Yes No ✓**	This rule changed effective 4/18/2023 and is now required under 419-470-0090(3)(a) Health Services Medical exams. • *No further corrective action is needed at this time*
Financial Records 419-470-0170 (4) Records contain date, amount, source, purpose, signatures. • Signatures were inconsistent. The agency shall ensure signatures are regularly obtained.	**Yes☐ No✓**	Financial records are being signed by both staff and the child in care. • *No further corrective action is needed at this time.* *Note: the administrative staff person recently implemented a weekly quality check to verify accurate documentation and initials when complete. This licensor recommended revising the log form to include a column for this review and signature.*

New Findings from Site Visit	Corrective Actions
Physical Plant Requirements 419-470-0020(2)(c) All areas of buildings where children in care are present must be kept clean and in good repair. Major appliances and heating, ventilation, plumbing, and electrical systems must be functional and in good repair.	All upstairs toilets had various levels of rings in the toilet indicating a deep cleaning and regular upkeep was lacking. It's recommended that the agency utilize Collaborative Problem Solving techniques to encourage the youth to meet cleaning expectations. • **Corrective Action:** The agency is ultimately responsible and must ensure agency staff are completing necessary cleaning. There is dark discolored flooring around one of the upstairs toilets indicating a potential water leak, mold, rotting floor, or other unknown reason. Mold is a health hazard, and a rotting floor structure is a safety concern. • **Corrective Action:** The agency shall seek out a professional assessment and remedy the problem.

Interview Summary
The program manager began a site tour with this licensor before attending the scheduled all-staff training. The current census is 6 with one potential new intake soon. Katie Wyland interviewed two youth and three staff. This licensor interviewed one youth and the in-house schoolteacher and met three newer staff and briefly talked with two longer term staff. **Youth Interviews:** Youth reported wanting to do more activities and get out of the program more. They've spent most of the summer break sitting around watching TV and playing video games in the downstairs main living room. They're not allowed to use the upstairs recreation room until after 3pm. Outings have included swimming, the park, or drives. They reported only two outings in the last two weeks. There's no structured daily physical activity time. Staff aren't following the outing or activity schedule that's posted. Groups haven't been happening. School starts next week, so they're hoping for more daily structure. There are staff that are trusting. With the recent staffing changes, it feels disorganized. Food is described as good, but there's a lot of frozen meals and approximately two cooked meals per week. Phone calls with approved contact persons occur at the end of each day for 15 minutes per youth, but it's a tight schedule to start/stop for the next youth to make a call. Phone calls occur at the kitchen table which provides semi-privacy as youth and staff might be walking thru or doing chores. One of the therapists recently left the agency, and the youth are seeing the other one, but it's reported their approach is more of a hands-off, listening type rather than helping them process through feelings or providing tools to work through feelings. **Staff Interviews:** Staff report that the youth need more routine and structure, and that there's been too much sitting watching TV and playing video games during the day. This is due to not having enough staff, especially due to the recently implemented staffing ratio for outings where if two youth go on an outing there must be two staff to accompany them, which means all youth go on the outing or there is no outing. Some youth lose outing privileges, due to safety concerns, which contributes to the staffing/outing dilemma. It was reported the funds for outings are not always sufficient, and there doesn't seem to be oversight of those funds or sufficient funds for the types of outings that may cost more. One staff reports that youth are going on outings 4-5 times a week, just not on day shift, and outings include YMCA for swimming (M, W & F), drives, bowling and, if funds allow, to the movies or coffee shop. There's been recent staff changes and the atmosphere among coworkers feels stressed. Schedules are all over the place. Hands-on training for new staff isn't happening as thoroughly i.e., showing a new staff person how to do a proper room check requires two staff to leave the floor, which is nearly impossible to accommodate; staff either don't know the house rules or they're not consistent with the house rules; and only receiving a 5-minute training on BRS service documentation. Staff report various levels of feeling comfortable going to management with concerns as well as mixed feedback about issues getting resolved or not. Staff expressed a desire to have the program manager be more involved on the floor on a regular basis, especially during times of staff changes, training, new client intakes and during times when client behaviors are challenging to manage.

Observations
The facility is an aging building, was originally built as a house, has original or aging bathrooms and some areas appear more worn down. The agency works at keeping it maintained and clean. A couple maintenance issues are noted above in “New Findings”. Youth bedrooms were observed and were relatively clean and tidy. Food was observed in the cupboards and in refrigerators and freezers. The walk-through consisted of the classroom, and all rooms, bathrooms, and common areas on the first and second floor of the residential side of the building. It was smokey outside due to wildfires, so the youth were inside finishing up breakfast and then in the living room either watching tv or playing video games. Staff had a scheduled training (in-person and virtual) soon after this licensor arrived, and accommodations were made to continue the unannounced visit.

Corrective Actions and Timeframes: Please submit the following to verify compliance.

Within 45 days of receipt of this report **Family Solutions** must submit a letter of verification indicating the agency is in compliance with the specific rules cited above and describing how compliance will be maintained going forward. Along with the letter of verification, the agency must submit any and all specific documentation requested in the body of this report. The letter of verification and any additional requested documents can be emailed directly to **robin.m.duval@dhsoha.state.or.us**.

Licensing Coordinator’s Signature: _____ Date: 9/12/2023

Manager Review: _____ Date: 9-12-2023